

Mitchell Dorward

Full-Stack Software Engineer

Full-stack software engineer with a rigorous CS foundation and hands-on RLHF experience training frontier LLMs. Specialized in AI/LLM systems, scalable backend architecture, and real-time web applications.

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[GitHub](#)



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Knoxville, TN

[Portfolio & Project Demos](#)

(mitchell-dorward.com)

Work Experience

AI/LLM Trainer & Prompt Engineer (RLHF) @ DataAnnotation (Jan 2025 - Current)

- Accumulated **1+ year** of hands-on LLM evaluation experience — representing roughly **25% of the commercial LLM era** — developing rare, practitioner-level insight into **model reasoning**, **failure modes**, and **prompt engineering** best practices.
- Evaluated and corrected **500+** LLM responses across reasoning, code, agentic, and creative tasks — improving output quality through structured **RLHF** feedback loops.
- Analyzed and modified **reasoning patterns** to decrease token usage and save cost.
- Analyzed **large codebases** (10k+ LOC) to identify **model failure modes** in refactoring, feature implementation, and bug-fixing tasks
- Leverage **AI tooling** daily to accelerate development, debugging, and research workflows

Summer Intern @ MonroeEnergy (Summer 2024)

- Represented the company in **community outreach** across public schools and residential neighborhoods, communicating **complex** pipeline safety information to **non-technical** audiences
- Managed time-sensitive **legal permit documentation** with zero errors in a high-accountability environment

Projects

[Unite-Pro.net](#)

Web App Linked

- Architected **stateless** backend and WebSocket multiplayer layer from scratch
- Developed **React.js** frontend that performs **AI analysis** and **Data Analysis** using a custom **postgreSQL** database.
- Crafted interactive and engaging **UI/UX** on **Mobile, Desktop, and Tablet** screens as a **solo dev**.

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Demo Videos Linked

- Iterated** on direct **feedback** received from **stakeholders** during weekly **demos**
- Deployed to a live beta of **100+** Lehigh students

Education

Lehigh University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science from the Rossin College of Engineering

GPA: 3.71 | Dean's List: 5 of 7 Semesters

Minors in Music and Spanish

TA For Artificial Intelligence for Games

- Redesigned autograder architecture for **scalability**, reducing manual grading overhead for a 100+ student course.
- Applied **algorithmic analysis** to build **dynamic test case generation**, catching edge cases missed by static test suites.

Skills

Languages & Frameworks

C, C++, C#, Lua, Go, Assembly, Java, JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML, CSS, Python, Rust, SQL

Node.js, React.js, Vue.js, jQuery, Tailwind

Software Engineering

REST APIs, Database Structure, Agile, Scrum, Git, Version Control, Unit Testing, System Design, Cloud (AWS/GCP/Azure)

Security Concepts

NIST, SHA-256, Hashing, Asymmetric Cryptographic Key Pair, Encryption / Decryption, Identity and Access Management

Advanced Skills

Multi-Threaded Programming, Compiler Design, Operating Systems, Embedded Systems, Data Structures, Containerization (Docker), CI/CD Pipeline, Linux, Understanding of the Internet (Application, Transport, Network, Link, and Physical layers)

AI / Machine Learning

A*, Deep Learning, Generative Algorithms, Backpropagation, Neural Nets, Kernels, Cross Validation, Heuristic Search, Metaheuristic Search

